UNIT-2-LECTURE-7
WORD STRESS



Department: Mathematics & Humanities

Yeshwantrao Chavan College of Engineering

Word Stress

- There are a number of words in every language with more than one syllable.
- Words- tai lor and tea cher- two syllables
- 1 2 1 2
- Fan tas tic, e ner gy, ex pen sive- **3 syllables**
- In an English word of more than one , one of the syllables is pronounced more prominently than the other.
- English words consisting of several syllables each, more than one syllable may be prominent.
- Eg.- examination- **/ig/ /zæ/ /mi/ /nei//ʃn/- five syllables**
- **1 2 3 4 5**
- The syllable that has maximum prominence is **/nei/ the forth syllable**

Word Stress

- **Primary accent** : it is marked with a vertical bar above and in front of the syllable to which it refers.(‘) con**'sider , 'com**fortable
- **Secondary Stress** : It is marked with a vertical bar below and in front of the syllable to which it refers. ( ) /ig**z**æmi **'n**eiʃn/

- **'con**scious, **'fa**mous, **'gra**cious, **'gor**geous, **'jea**lous
- dedi**'ca**tion, at**'ten**tion, transfor**'ma**tion, compre**'hen**sion
- sin**'cer**ity, chro**'nol**ogy, inspi**'rat**ional, hypo**'the**tical
- Ex**'pre**ssion, en**'thu**siasm, me**'ta**bolism

Word Stress- Rules

i)Compound Words: -Primary accent falls on one of the two elements

first of the two elements receives the accent

- **'air**- raid
- **'Book**shelf
- **'Cross**word
- **'foot**print

ii) Compound Words :with **_ever and __self , second element** receives the primary stress.

- her**'self**
- my **'self**
- how'**ever**
- when'**ever**

Word Stress- Rules

iii)Compound word where both the elements are accented, but primary accent falls on the second element:

-after '**noon**

- home- '**made**

-Good-'**looking**

-Vice- **'Chancellor**

iv) Words with **weak prefixes** always take the accent on the **root word**:

-a'**lone**

-be'**cause**

-be'**come**

-be'**low**

-be'**neath**

Word Stress- Rules

v) **The inflexional suffixes-**__ed, _es, ___and __ing do not affect the accent.

-re'late re'lated

- sub'mit sub'mitted

- dis'ease dis'eases

- 'happen 'happening

vi) The **derivational suffixes** - ___age, _ance, _en,_er, __ess, _ful, _hood, _ice, _ish, __ ive, less, __ly, _ment, _ness, _____or, ___ship,___ter,___ure and __zen do not normally affect the accent.

'carry	'carriage	'brother	**'brotherhood**
'bright	'brighten	'colour	**'colourless**
'begin	'beginner	'manage	**'management**
'beauty	'beautiful	'city	**'citizen**

Word Stress- Rules

vi) Words ending in ____ion take the primary accent on the **penultimate (last but one)** syllable.

egs: ad mi **'ra tion** 'nation
app li **'ca tion** pre pa **'ra tion**
de co**'ra tion** com bi**'na tion**
e xa mi **'na tion** determi**'nation**
Ad 'mi ssion

vii) Words ending in- _ic, _ical,__ically, __ious, ___ial, and ___ially take the primary accent on the syllable **preceding the suffix**.(before the suffix)

egs: pa**'the tic** e**'lectrica**l eco'**nomically**
no'**torious** me**'morial** com'**mercially**

Word Stress- Rules

vii) Words ending in - ___ ity take the accent on the **ante- penultimate syllable**, or the third syllable from the end.

egs: a'**bi li ty,** ca'**pacity** elec'**tricity**

e'normity fu'**ti li ty** oppor'**tunity**

ge ne'**ro si ty** ra tio '**na li ty**

Questions?

- Q1.Explain the rule of primary accent on Penultimate syllable.
- Q2.What is the ante- penultimate rule of accent?
- Q3. Put the primary stress/ accent for the words given below:
- i) att**'ention,**
- ii) transfor**' ma tion,**
- iii)compre'hen sion
- iv) accountancy,
- v) sincerity,
- vi)chronology,
- vii)inspirational
- viii) zealous, ,
- ix) conscious
- x) famous